THE EASTERN HOTSPOTS

Indian and Chinese soldiers have clashed at various points on the 1,080 km-long LAC along Arunachal Pradesh

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY



frontiers—have grown markedly more aggressive in the Arunachal sector over the past few months.

Locals have repeatedly flagged Chinese presence in remote areas in Arunachal. In late June 2026, the Nah Welfare Society, a community organisation representing tribal residents in Taksing, submitted a formal memorandum to the district deputy commissioner of Upper Subansiri. It expressed "deep grief" over what it described as the occupation of ancestral lands by the PLA and claimed that the Chinese had constructed roads, bridges, camps and other infrastructure in areas considered Indian territory. The letter named five locations: Oying (Asaphila area), Paniar (Chujarta area), Marpan (Marnafe), Potrang Lake and Tindingtang.

Speaking to INDIA TODAY over the phone, one resident alleges that the PLA crossed the LAC at Shera 4 and 5 (patrolling points in the Taksing sector), took control of the Portang Lake.



"INDIA MUST ADAPT ITS BORDER DEFENCE TO THE REALITIES OF MODERN WARFARE, WHERE DRONES AND INTELLIGENCE, SURVEILLANCE AND RECONNAISSANCE SYSTEMS ARE AS CRITICAL AS TROOPS AND INFRASTRUCTURE"

— LT GEN. ANIL AHUJA (RETD)
Former Deputy Chief, Integrated Defence Staff

In August, a fact-finding team from the People's Party of Arunachal Pradesh (PPA) also alleged that the PLA had denied the Indian Army access to key patrolling points in Taksing.

Lt Gen. Rakesh Sharma (retd), former commander of the Leh-based 14 Corps, notes that since the Galwan clash in eastern ladakh in June 2020, India has a principle: Chinese troops must not be allowed to establish a presence in areas claimed by India. This has raised the risk of scuffles. "From Ladakh to Arunachal, we have decided to deploy our men in forward areas to prevent a Galwan-type situation," he says.

"India must adapt its border defence